

CDN Incident Alert: 0111. TLP: CLEAR**Date****Title** SK TV OTV - A Russian influence Tool

23/03/2026

Summary

- TV OTV is a significant source of disinformation and sanctioned Russian content that contributes to several types of societal harm: anti-EU narratives, political polarisation, inciting hatred towards journalists, NGOs and any type of social activism.
- The stated behaviour clearly constitutes a form of hybrid activity and the dissemination of pro-Russian narratives that are aligned with the foreign policy interests of Kremlin.
- Russia is a victim of Western aggression, while the real culprits behind the world's instability are USA and NATO, Ukraine is corrupt, the West is a threat to traditional values, while Russia protects them.
- TV OTV has over 91 000 followers and subscribers on social media.
- The operation is working to degrade the West, Ukraine, and NATO by Appropriating Content from the Russian Information Space, hiding their origin, and spread them through existing inauthentic news websites.
- TV OTV's activity should be geofenced or reviewed by the hosting social platforms.

Incident

TV OTV acted as a node within a coordinated multilingual operation that spreads content from the Russian state information space across several European countries and platforms. It was founded in 2021 by journalism graduate Lenka Zlatev, starting out as a semi-professional Slovak online TV channel. Its www domain tvotv.sk had been registered previously in 2020.

Their main activity is videos posted on YouTube regularly - mainly interviews with politically exposed persons, including official representatives of the Russian Federation. Often, among the guests are well-known Slovak disinformation actors, most of them pro-Russian. Its staff obtained accreditations for entry into both the Slovak Parliament and the European Parliament. They attended receptions at the Russian Embassy in Bratislava and conducted interviews with the military attaché and a State Duma representative.

TV OTV expanded to Telegram shortly after Russia's invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, and beginning in June 2022, they stopped posting under individual editors' names and became part of a broader network. They began synchronising with 8 other Telegram channels created for different European countries (SK, CZ, PL, IR, DE, IT, FR, ES, HU).

Thus, identical content was posted simultaneously in nine different languages, reaching up to 200 posts per day. The posts, drawing especially from Russian sources (even those on EU sanction list), originated and were coordinated via the Czech account Selsky rozum. The Czech account Selsky rozum created and distributed newsfeeds to the rest of the mentioned channels via the associated bot account on Telegram @selsky_rozum_bot.

After the exposure of this operation in October 2024, the Slovak account TVOTV.sk stopped sharing automated news from Selsky rozum on Telegram. The number of their posts decreased significantly; however, they keep producing their own propaganda-oriented content and laundering from alternative sources.

In 2025, the Czech counterintelligence service independently confirmed the findings of the Hoaxy a podvody team.

Narrative

Meta-narrative 1: Russia is systematically depicted as a victim of Western aggression, while USA and NATO are the real culprits behind the world's instability.

Sub-Narrative 1-1: Conflicts are framed as an inevitable reaction to NATO expansion or

"fascism" in Ukraine.

Meta-narrative 2: Inducing fear of economic collapse due to EU policies.

Sub-Narrative 2-1: Europe will go bankrupt due to cutting off Russian resources.

Sub-Narrative 2-2: Sanctions against Russia are presented exclusively as European self-harm that has no impact on Russia itself.

Impact and Outcome

Reach: TV OTV has almost 28 000 followers on Facebook and Telegram, on YouTube they have reached over 65 000 subscribers.

Outcome: TV OTV is viewed by security experts as a hybrid threat has been harming society by systematically spreading foreign propaganda, inciting hatred toward journalists and activists and undermining the foundations of democratic discourse.

Key Objectives and Behaviours

Objective 1: [T0066: Degrade Adversary](#): the content spreads derogatory narratives “West is weak and aggressive”, “Ukraine is corrupt”, “NATO is fracturing”

[T0084.004: Appropriate Content](#): The pages are republishing content from sanctioned entities.

[T0129.009: Remove Post Origins](#): The entity hides the origin of the content.

[T0098.002: Leverage Existing Inauthentic News Sites](#): Russian officials are leveraging this entity to spread their narratives to foreign audiences, instead of their own sanctioned entities.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions Taken: Multiple articles and reports have been published on this case by different institutions.

Rep ort	Threat Actor	Authors	Platforms	FIMI assessment
N/A	Russia	Ruzena Alaksova, Hoaxy a podvody	Web, YouTube, Telegram, Facebook.	High Certainty

Evidence

<https://archive.ph/W83Dj> - <https://archive.ph/HHTL5> - <https://archive.ph/oaiaa> -
<https://archive.ph/1uHwa> - <https://archive.ph/kQiog> - <https://archive.ph/2TgZy> -
<https://archive.ph/7226P> - <https://archive.ph/f8Nwm> - <https://archive.ph/skCoU>